The Coffee-Fueled Courage of Adora Grey

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Bow & Glimmer (She-Ra)

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by SnackinDaster

Summary

Adora recently started working at the café Glimmer and Bow work at so she can cut back on her student loans. And lo and behold, she's immediately started pining for one of their patrons.

Let's hope she deals with that smoothly, shall we?

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

"Bye!" The cute girl who'd been studying in a corner for half an hour finally left with a wave, doorbell dinging as the door shut behind her.

Adora perked up. "Thank you so much! Please come again!" She waved back a bit too enthusiastically, flailing the cloth she'd been wiping the counter down with around her head. She blushed, lowering her hand. *Okay, at least she's already out of here and didn't see that.*

The girl smiled at her through the window . She waved again and walked off, just as Adora blushed so hard she felt like she was about to combust, wanting nothing more to disappear through a hole in the floor.

Instead of disappearing (as much as she'd liked to), she walked to the coffee machines, where Glimmer was cleaning one of the machine's group heads, clearing her throat. "So, uhm, Glimmer… hypothetically…"

"Hypothetically? Uh-oh. Fancy words. Will I like where this is going?" Glimmer panned, not looking up from her work.

Adora rolled her eyes. "Shut up, you don't know what I'm going to say." She paused, looking at the pretty much deserted cof fee shop. "Hypothetically , in theory, just to be sure… I… uh, would be bad form to ask out one of our patrons, right?"

Glimmer made an unidentifiable snorting noise as she jerked up, almost knocking a few cups down from the counter. "What?! Whomst!?"

"No-one! I just-"

"Nu-uh Adora. You've worked here for all but a week and you're already planning to hit on a customer? Disaster Lesbian Incorporated venturing back out onto the dating scene the second she enters a service job?" Glimmer cornered her with a devious grin.

"I'm just saying-"

"I think she's pining after the studying girl." Bow piped in, emerging from the supply room, bag of coffee beans slung over his shoulder.

"Bow!"

"Oooh, juicy." Glimmer practically cooed. "Yeah, now that I think about it, she does keep coming in quite often, but only stays longer when you're around. Your little crush might even be reciprocated."

"I don't have a crush!"

"You literally just questioned me about the morality of asking out one of our patrons. Which, by the way, you shouldn't care about."

"But our behaviour reflects on the company-"

"Yeah, and that company's pay reflects minimum wage that literally only *softens* the necessity of student loans, so get nasty in the storeroom while on the clock, for all I care."

"Ew!" Bow and Adora shouted in unison.

"Yeah, okay, maybe not. But what gives? You think this girl's cute, she keeps sticking around when you're on shift - might as well give it a shot, right? What's the worst that could happen?"

"Uh, awkward rejection while on the job, word getting out about what happened, an *ex* getting word of it, leading to the heat death of my social life?"

"Come on, Adora. I get that you're nervous about asking someone out again after all that's happened, but this could be great!" Bow interjected. "Her name's Catra, and the course she keeps studying in here for - and struggling with, I might add - is Principles of Electrodynamics." He added, smiling innocently.

Adora's eyes widened at this new wealth of information. "I love that course! I aced it last year! How do you even know all this? Have you been secretly stalking her?"

Cackling a laugh, Glimmer shook her head. "C'mon, do you even remember who you're talking to?"

"I'll take that as a compliment, Glimmer." Bow ruffled Glimmer's hair lightly. "But no, I just asked when you weren't on-shift yesterday. That's all info I'm giving you, though. You'll just have to ask her if she comes in again."

Oh, well, darn. Now there's pressure on it. "Alright. Thanks Bow." Adora took a deep breath. "Sure, I'll ask her."

"Hah, I'll believe it when I see-Ow! Hey!" Glimmer was interrupted as Bow poked her warningly with his elbow.

--

Adora took a deep breath. Okay – this was about as ideal as it would get. Rush hour over, just a few students still sitting in the shop, chatting quietly. Catra was studying at a table in a corner, huddled over thick textbooks, notes, and a laptop, bathed in the orange light of the late spring afternoon. In Adora's hands was clasped a cup of plain black filter coffee – a refill of her usual order. With a nod, she left the counter and approached Catra's table. The other girl didn't look up. The way Glimmer and Bow had been egging on all day Adora had almost started thinking Catra studied *her* more than her books, but she seemed in deep focus mode. *You got this, Adora.* Before she could think about backing out, though, she spoke up.

"Hey."

Catra snapped out of her reverie, looking up, startled. "Oh, shit – hi, is it closing time already? Should I get out of here?"

"Oh, nonono!" Adora shook her head violently, shaking the coffee to the point that it almost spilled. "I just, uh- I wanted to offer you a refill! On the house." She thrust out the cup to Catra, arms stretched out.

"Oh!" Catra seemed to relax, smiling and accepting the cup. "Thank you."

"So, uh." Adora clasped her hands in front of her, eyes straying from Catra to the pile on the table – textbooks, notes, and laptop chaotically covering pretty much the entire surface. "Electrodynamics, huh?"

Catra looked confused before nodding, slumping back in her chair with a sigh. "Yeah, electrodynamics."

"Nice! I loved that course! Are you enjoying it so far?"

"Enjoying it? Are you kidding me? Maxwell and his stupid stress tensors are driving me up the wall. Calculus isn't my thing."

"Not one for vector algebra, huh?"

The other woman scoffed, running a hand through her hair. "You can say that again. I used to be fine with algebra in general, but something about this just turns my brains to mush. Especially since Advanced Calc."

Adora's mind ran a blank, running out of things to say – and with that, running out of excuses to ask what she'd come out here to ask in the first place. "So, uh. Would you, sometime, like to"… *Go on a date? No, too forward.* "Uh"… *Grab a coffee together? Look at where you* work*, Adora, that'd be stupid.* "Study together sometime?"

Oh, you dumb idiot. Study? That's not a date, that's tutoring.

"Like I said, I liked that course a lot! I even followed the follow-up course, so I could help you out!"

That doesn't sound more like a date. At all.

"Oh?" Catra looked taken aback for a second, almost flustered. "Uh. Su-"

"No! Wait, sorry, uh." Adora interrupts. Immediately, like some dark presence, she felt Glimmer's eyes burning into her back, as if the bubble gum menace sensed Adora's temptation to back out. "What I actually mean is if you want to go on a date."

"Excuse me?"

"Uhm. I actually meant to ask if you'd like to go on a date. With me. Not studying, that'd be stupid as a first date, of course. Maybe have coffee, or something? No, wait, you're already having coffee, heh, maybe a movie, or dinner, or-"

"You know, I think I'd like that."

Adora blinked. "You- You would?"

"Yeah, sure."

For how calm and collected Catra sounded, Adora could see the faintest trace of a blush on her cheeks. Though the observation was, in fairness, a bit hypocritical. "Cool, uh. Maybe we could." Gears turning. "Uh"…

"Didn't think this far ahead?"

Adora shook her head. "Not really."

"How about you give me your number, and I can text you some suggestions?"

"Uhm. Sure!" Adora took a pen and a notebook from her apron, quickly jotting down her phone number. Just as she put it down on Catra's table, she froze. "Wait! I'm the one who asked you. Aren't I supposed to... You know. Come up with this? Ask for *your* number?"

"Says who?" Catra retorted with a wink, taking the note and whipping out her phone. A few seconds later, Adora's own phone dinged with a message.

[16:47] [Unknown number]: Dinner sounds good! What time does your shift end?

Adora grinned widely. "In about ten minutes!"

And so on a date they went. Needless to say, they had a great time.

End Notes

This was initially supposed to be the start of "The Sudden and Unprovoked Attack of Adora's Reading Glasses", but when writing that I felt that it'd get out of hand if I turned that into a full-on coffee store AU (which is what it's need to become to get at where I wanted that to be). And because I already HAVE a complicated AU brewing, I then stopped myself and just skipped to what that fic was.

But then I revisited the first few hundred words of this, thought it was cute, and decided to finish it. This will probably be the final work in my Prompts and Coffee oneshot-AU, but you never know. Funnily enough, I wrote it in exactly the wrong order - in the end this is the first part.

I hope you enjoyed!:) Enjoy your day! (Or evening, or night, or ... Whichever)

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!